

Refund Logic & Return Policy Specification

This document details the exact business rules, boundary checks, and edge-case behaviors required for our automated return chatbot. It serves as the operational contract for backend database queries, frontend UI logic, and QA test execution.

1. Order Verification & Lookup Rules

Rule 1.1 Order ID Syntax Check

Before making a database call, validate that the user's input follows our standard order numbering scheme

(ORD-XXXXX with 5 alphanumeric characters following the hyphen).

- If format is incorrect: Display prompt: "That order number doesn't look quite right. Please double-check your receipt and enter it in the format ORD-10023."
- If format is valid: Proceed directly to database verification.

Rule 1.2 Database Record Lookup

Query the Supabase orders table using the provided order ID.

- If order is not found: Display prompt: "We couldn't find an order matching that number in our system. Please check your order confirmation email and try again."
- If order is found: Fetch `purchase_date` , `item_category` , and `return status` , then move to eligibility evaluation.

2. General Return Window Logic

Rule 2.1 Dynamic Date Calculation

Determine elapsed days dynamically at runtime using:

Days Since Purchase = Current Date – Purchase Date

Rule 2.2 Standard Automated Approval (≤ 30 Days)

If Days Since Purchase ≤ 30 , the order is marked Delivered , and the item is not restricted, approve the return automatically.

Bot Action: Message user: "Your order is eligible for a return. We've generated your prepaid return shipping label below." Display the label link and instructions on how to drop off the package.

Rule 2.3 Expired Return Window (> 30 Days)

If Days Since Purchase > 30 , the order has passed our standard automated return window.

Bot Action: Message user: "Standard returns must be requested within 30 days of delivery. Because this purchase was made over 30 days ago, I'm handing this over to a support representative to review your case."

System Action: Route user immediately to the Human Agent Escalation View.

3. Specific Policy Exceptions & Edge Cases

A. Final Sale Items

Rule 3.1 Non-Returnable Products

Items flagged in the database as clearance, final sale, or intimate wear cannot be returned through the automated portal under any circumstance, regardless of when they were purchased.

Bot Action: Message user: "This item was purchased as a Final Sale item and isn't eligible for return or store credit under our shop policy." End the return workflow.

B. Previously Processed Orders

Rule 3.2 Checking Active Return Status

Check the return status field in the database before processing a request.

- If return_status == 'Pending' : Respond: "A return label has already been issued for this order. Please check your email inbox to download and print it."
- If return_status == 'Refunded' : Respond: "This order has already been fully processed and refunded."

C. Damaged or Defective Items (Fast-Track Handoff)

Rule 3.3 Damaged Goods Process

If a customer selects "Item Arrived Damaged / Defective" as their return reason, bypass the standard 30-day calculation entirely. Our team needs human review and visual proof to issue replacements or overrides.

1. Collect Proof: Prompt the customer to upload a clear photo of the damaged item and add a brief note describing what went wrong.
2. Generate Support Ticket: Create a new ticket record containing the order_id , uploaded image link, and customer note.
3. Agent Handoff: Display message: "We're so sorry your item arrived damaged! I've created support ticket #[Ticket_ID] with your details and photo. Transferring you to an agent now so we can get this sorted out for you right away."
4. System Action: Place user in the priority Live Support Queue with ticket details pre-attached.

Summary Matrix for Bot Responses:

Customer Scenario	Bot Response Message	Next System State
Standard Return (≤ 30 Days)	"Your order is eligible for a return! Click below to download your prepaid return label."	Show Label Button
Expired Window (> 30 Days)	"This order was purchased over 30 days. Connecting you with a support rep."	Escalation Screen

Final Sale Purchase	"This item was purchased as Final Sale and isn't eligible for return under our shop policy."	End Workflow
Already Refunded / Label Sent	"A return or refund for this order has already been created. Check your email for details."	End Workflow
Damaged or Defective Item	"We're sorry to hear that! Please attach a photo and note so an agent can arrange a replacement."	Generate Ticket & Pass to Live Agent